

YAHYA MDARHRI

Data Project Manager | Data Scientist | PMP® Certified

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

PMP®-certified Data Scientist moving into project management, with 3 years of experience leading digital, data, and innovation projects within the Vice-Presidency for Research, Development, innovation & Partnerships at the International University of Rabat. Combines hands-on expertise in data science, data engineering, and machine learning with a solid command of project management standards (PMP®, ongoing Master's in Project & Program Management) to scope, deliver, and deploy results-driven data solutions, coordinating technical teams and stakeholders up to the highest institutional level.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Digital Research & Development Engineer [International University of Rabat \(UIR\)](#) Dec. 2023 – Present

Rabat, Morocco • Vice-Presidency for Research, Development, innovation & Partnerships

- **Research Intelligence Platform: End-to-end project lead (PMI/PMP standards).** Faced with 360+ researchers tracked manually in scattered Excel files with no single source of truth, I scoped the need, then designed and deployed a data solution as a full project lifecycle. The platform became the university's real-time single source of truth, now at the core of institutional communications and activity reports.
- **University Rankings Lead.** To strengthen UIR's positioning in international rankings (THE, THE Impact, QS), I led and coordinated stakeholders across the entire university to acquire, analyze, optimize, and submit ranking data, turning a fragmented process into a structured, repeatable submission cycle.
- **"Inn2Market" project: Patent ideation & valorization.** The patent ideation and valorization process relied on scattered paperwork and manual follow-up, making it hard to track ideas from submission to industrial uptake. Working with the Technology Transfer Office and industrial partners, I led the requirements gathering, planning, and delivery to move it from a paper-based process to a structured data system, giving stakeholders a single, trackable pipeline from idea to market.
- **Strategic research-database negotiations.** Facing costly renewals for key databases (Scopus, ScienceDirect), I led negotiations backed by usage-data analysis to inform renewal decisions and optimize institutional spending.
- **"Tamkeen for Cities" labeling program.** The labeling of sustainable and innovative cities was run manually, with criteria and supporting evidence assessed by hand, slow to process and hard to compare across cities. In partnership with the Innovation & Entrepreneurship Center and the Ministry of the Interior, I introduced a data-driven approach that structured the evaluation criteria and evidence into a digital workflow, making the labeling process faster, more consistent, and scalable across cities.
- **Institutional governance.** Contributed to institutional governance as a member of the R&D ethics committee and the university's environmental committee.

AI / ML Engineer (Remote) [Niloom \(formerly abxr\)](#)

2023 - ~5 months

New York, USA (distributed team)

- **AI-driven content generation for AR/VR.** Led the development of an AI assistant that generates AR/VR scenes automatically, and built generative-AI capabilities to create 3D assets from scratch. Core features of the startup's world-class AR/VR product, delivered within an internationally distributed engineering team.

Business Intelligence Engineer [Sanlam Data Factory](#)

2022

Casablanca, Morocco

- **Financial & accounting reporting.** Designed and deployed financial and accounting dashboards in Tableau, transforming raw, unstructured data into decision-ready reporting used to support business monitoring.

SELECTED PROJECT

- **Arabic Named Entity Recognition (NER) System** [Medtech Group](#). Developed and published an Arabic NER model on Hugging Face that surpassed 50,000 downloads, addressing the scarcity of production-ready Arabic NLP resources.

SKILLS

Project & Program Management: PMI / PMP®, Agile (Scrum), scoping & requirements gathering, planning, risk & budget management, stakeholder management, change management, reporting, and negotiation.

Data Science & Machine Learning: Python, machine learning, Deep learning, NLP (NER), model design & training, deployment, exploratory & statistical analysis.

Data Engineering & BI: Data pipelines, web scraping, SQL, ETL, workflow automation, Business Intelligence and data visualization.

Cloud & Tools: Cloud computing, collaborative development environments, institutional data management & reliability.

Soft Skills: Team leadership & coordination, communication and knowledge translation for executives, stakeholder management, negotiation, analytical & results-oriented mindset, autonomy, adaptability, distributed teamwork.

EDUCATION

Master's in Project & Program Management — Rabat Business School	Expected 2027
State Engineering Degree — Data Science & Cloud Computing — ENSA Oujda	2023
Baccalaureate — Mathematical Sciences, Option B — Rabat	2018

CERTIFICATIONS

- Project Management Professional (PMP)® — Project Management Institute (PMI), 2026.

VOLUNTEERING

Citizen Mentor (Volunteer) — Les Citoyens

- Supported the association's data-driven citizen initiatives (public-interest censuses and studies led by civil society) and mentored teams during data hackathons and events.

LANGUAGES

Arabic (native) • French (professional) • English (professional)